

Operation Phish Phry

FBI launched the Operation Phish Phry in year 2007 and by the time the operation was over, the agency had managed to catch 100 cyber criminals who were involved in phishing.

Cyber warfare

One form of hacking, the denial-of-service (DoS) attack, has now evolved as a tool of war. These attacks are designed to paralyse websites, financial networks and other computer systems by flooding them with useless data from outside computers.



ADRIAN LAMO

(Born 1981)

Adrian Lamo has been making lot of news lately, primarily because of his ongoing tussle with the whistle blower web site WikiLeaks. Although he has taken a dip in the world of cyber crime his claim to fame is rather odd. Intelligence officer Bradley Manning had contacted Adrian Lamo over IM to brag about the fact that he was responsible for leaking thousands of documents to WikiLeaks. Lamo promptly tipped off the FBI with this information.

Since then many in the hacker community have been bombarding Lamo with death threats for cooperating with the authorities, but there are also those who call him a national hero. Born in Boston, Lamo spent his early childhood in Arlington, Virginia, before moving to Bogotá, Colombia at the age of 10.

Two years later when he came back to USA, he became obsessed with computers and software. He was barely out of his teens when he started performing authorised or unauthorised vulnerability assessment for several large and small business entities. However, most of his work was done for free. In February 2002 after breaking into The New York Times computer network, he added his name to the internal database of expert sources, and began using the paper's LexisNexis account to conduct research on high-profile subjects. The newspaper filed a complaint and warrant for Lamo's arrest was issued in August 2003. Later on he was convicted of compromising the security of The New York Times, Microsoft, Yahoo! and MCI WorldCom.

CHAD DAVIS

(Born 1981)

The founding member of the globalHell syndicate of hackers, Chad Davis used to operate under the pseudonym, Mindphaser. He is suspected to have played a lead role in the hacking of the web sites of numerous businesses and government agencies. Two weeks after he vandalised the web site of the White House, in June 1999, the authorities searched his apartment. As Chad Davis was underage at that time, he could not be arrested; the cops only fined him \$165 for a can of beer that was found in his refrigerator. Within days of the search, Chad Davis retaliated by hacking the home page of the US Army, where he posted the message, "globalHell will not die." This time Chad was taken into custody and in 2001, and after he had pled guilty to the crime of hacking, he was sentenced to six months in prison. The judge also sentenced him to six months of probation, during which period he was ordered to stay away from computers.



JEANSON JAMES ANCHETA

(Born 1985)

Jeanson James Ancheta enjoys the notoriety of being the first person in the world to be convicted of controlling large numbers of hijacked computers or botnets. At one point of time he used to control more than half a million computers, which allowed him to orchestrate large-scale attacks. For

this crime, he had to spend five years in jail. He was accused of making profit of more than \$70,000 by installing adware on his hijacked computers or botnets. Born in USA, Ancheta attended the Downey High School in California until 2001, when he dropped out of school. After that he is known to have spent some time with the alternative program for students with academic or behavioural problems. He also worked at an internet cafe and from June 2004, he started his work with botnets.

JAN DE WIT

(Born 1981)

Sort of a misfit on this list, this hacker is not nearly as much a computer genius as he is a shrewd observer of human nature. Almost ten years have passed since the famous Anna Kournikova worm spread round the globe. The virus tempted users with naked pictures of the tennis diva and instead they found themselves infected with a malicious email-aware worm once they downloaded the package. What's interesting about this story is that the Netherlands-based, Jan de Wit wasn't a computer wizard; of course, he knew a little bit about coding and things like that, but the Anna Kournikova worm was made

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out of very basic form of Visual Basic Script (VBS). The worm was successful in wrecking havoc primarily because of its innovative socially viral strategy of reaching lot of users through user's outlook address books. You see a message from a contact saying: "Hi: Check This!", with what appears to be a picture file labelled "AnnaKournikova.jpg.vbs". For his crime Jan de Wit was sentenced for 75 days in jail.

Microsoft Security has recently identified these threats

- Trojan:Java/Koladeiter.A
- Trojan:Win32/Fibebol.A
- Trojan:Win32/Qhost.JO
- Backdoor:Win32/Momibot
- Virus:Win32/Kheagol.D
- Worm:Win32/Phorpiex.A
- TrojanSpy:AndroidOS/DroidDream.A
- Virus:Win32/Kheagol.C
- Exploit:Java/CVE-2010-0844.D
- TrojanDownloader:Java/OpenConnection.JS